

Diagnosis: Students pay and use TutorAI directly in the LMS/web study flow. The product can measure completed jobs, retention and payment behavior; D30 cohort retention is the first light before scaling acquisition.

NORTH STAR D30 cohort retention >= 40% | Current: not measured | Status: instrumenting

Three-tier light tree

ID	Metric	Definition	Current and thresholds	Cadence / owner	Warns / rule
L-01	Activation 7d	Completed job in 7d / qualified testers	Not measured Green >=60% Yellow 40-59.9% Red <40% [TB]	Weekly Product Ops	D30 retention R-01
L-02	D30 retention	Active at D30 / activated cohort	Not measured Green >=40% Yellow 25-39.9% Red <25% [TB]	Monthly Product Ops	LTV/CAC R-02
O-01	Observed containment	Completed with no retry/handoff / attempted credits	80% planning Green >=80% Yellow 67.8-79.9% Red <67.8% [MH-02]	Weekly Product Ops	Cost/job, GM R-03
O-02	AI cost / completed job	Direct AI COGS / completed jobs	2,250 VND planning Green <=2,250 Yellow 2,251-3,316 Red >3,316 [MH-01]	Weekly FinOps	GM and quota R-04
O-03	Trial-to-paid 4w	Paid in 28d / activated students at 28d	Not measured Green >=30% Yellow 15-29.9% Red <15% [TB]	Monthly Growth Ops	LTV/CAC R-05
G-01	Plan gross margin	(Revenue - direct COGS) / revenue	72.9% planning Green >=60% Yellow 50-59.9% Red <50% [MH-01]	Monthly Finance	Runway, pricing R-04
G-02	Observed LTV/CAC	Retained gross profit / fully-loaded CAC	Not measured Green >=3.0x Yellow 1.5-2.9x Red <1.5x [TB]	Quarterly Finance	Acquisition scale R-05

Decision rules

ID	IF WINDOW SAMPLE	THEN	NOT THEN	STOP
R-01	Activation <40% 2 weekly cohorts >=30 testers/cohort	Stop new cohorts for 14d; fix one onboarding step	Do not increase paid ads	STOP
R-02	D30 retention <25% 2 D30 cohorts >=25 activated/cohort	Sprint on the 3 largest failure slices	Do not add unrelated features	
R-03	Containment <67.8% 2 weeks >=100 attempts/week	Reduce quota, repair routing, rerun eval slice	Do not expand acquisition	STOP
R-04	Cost/job >3,316 VND 2 weeks >=100 jobs/week	Limit context, route model tier, retain QA	Do not cut QA or retry logs	
R-05	Trial-to-paid <15% 2 months >=30 offered/cohort	Turn off paid channel; interview 10 non-converters	Do not lower price broadly	

90-day gates

WHEN	ONE METRIC / THRESHOLD	PHYSICAL EVIDENCE	DECISION
Day 30	Activation 7d >=60% on >=30 testers	Event log + 10 redacted interviews	GO / FIX
Day 60	Observed containment >=67.8% on >=100 attempts	Versioned eval output + routing log	GO / PIVOT
Day 90	Plan gross margin >=60% on >=30 subscriptions / 4 weeks	Billing export + COGS ledger	GO / KILL

KILL CRITERIA: At Day 90, stop expanding paid self-serve if plan gross margin remains below 60% after two cost-optimization cycles and a 30-subscription cohort cannot sustain the threshold for four weeks.

Data lineage: Day 24 provides the ARPU and CAC assumptions; Day 25 provides the hybrid pricing, 30 attempts, 80% planning containment, 24 completed jobs and 54,000 VND direct monthly COGS.

MH-01 Maximum Cost / Completed Job

INPUTS ARPU 199,000 VND/month; minimum GM 60%; 24 completed jobs/month.

CALCULATION $199,000 \times (1 - 60\%) = 79,600$ VND monthly COGS ceiling. $79,600 / 24 = 3,316.67$ VND/job.

Red when Cost/Job > 3,316 VND. Green planning level: <= 2,250 VND/job.

MH-02 Minimum containment

INPUTS Direct COGS 54,000 VND/month; 30 credits; 6,633.33 VND/credit; target GM 60%.

CALCULATION $54,000 / (6,633.33 \times (1 - 60\%) \times 30) = 67.84\%$ containment.

Red below 67.8%. Green planning level: >= 80%; paid expansion pauses below floor.

Evidence plan for measures not yet observed

UNKNOWN METRIC	REQUIRED PHYSICAL EVIDENCE	OWNER	DATE AVAILABLE
D30 cohort retention	Pseudonymized activation and completed-job cohort event log	Product Operations	2026-11-26
Observed containment	100-session eval output with retry and unsupported-handoff reasons	Product Operations	2026-10-27
Fully-loaded LTV/CAC	Cohort revenue, retained gross profit, paid-media spend and growth labor ledger	Finance	2027-02-28

Operating posture

What is known

The Day 24-25 numbers form a traceable planning model: 199,000 VND ARPU, 54,000 VND direct COGS, 2,250 VND Cost/Job and 72.9% plan GM.

What is not claimed

No TutorAI learning gain, retention, conversion, containment, CAC or billing result has been observed yet. These metrics remain instrumented plans until cohort evidence exists.

Decision discipline

Retention must improve before paid acquisition scales; containment and Cost/Job protect GM; decision rules prevent discounting, cutting QA or buying more traffic to hide weak product signals.